

100 Days of Linux - Day 006

Title: Copying Files and Directories with cp

Today's Goal

Learn how to copy files and directories using the **cp** command.

Why This Matters

Copying files is a daily task when creating backups, duplicating configuration files, or working with datasets.

Command of the Day: cp

Syntax: cp SOURCE DESTINATION

Explanation: Copies files from one location to another.

Common Options:

cp -r source_dir destination_dir (copy directories)

cp -i source destination (ask before overwrite)

Examples:

cp notes.txt backup.txt

cp -r project project_backup

Beginner Lesson

Unlike **mv**, the **cp** command leaves the original file unchanged and creates a duplicate. Use **ls** after copying to verify your work.

Practice Questions

1. Create a file named notes.txt and copy it to notes_backup.txt.
2. Create a directory named backup and copy notes.txt into it.
3. List the contents of the backup directory to verify the copy.
4. Create a directory named project and copy it to project_copy using the appropriate option.
5. Display your current working directory.

Hints

Remember: copying directories requires a special option. Use ls to verify your results.

Mini Challenge

Create a folder named practice. Inside it create files app.py, data.csv, and report.txt. Copy the entire practice folder to practice_backup.

Common Mistakes

Trying to copy a directory without using the -r option.

Did You Know?

Many Linux administrators create backups before editing important configuration files.

Pro Tip

Use `cp -i` when you're unsure whether a destination file already exists.

Answer Key (Instructor Only)

Q1: `touch notes.txt && cp notes.txt notes_backup.txt`

Q2: `mkdir backup && cp notes.txt backup/`

Q3: `ls backup`

Q4: `mkdir project && cp -r project project_copy`

Q5: `pwd`

Homework

Practice copying five files and one directory until you're comfortable with the syntax.

Next Day Preview

Tomorrow you'll learn how to move and rename files using the `mv` command.